General rule – environmental hazards · "Playing the Game" chapter of SRD 5.2.1

The world deals **hazards**: falling, suffocation, fire, extreme cold or heat, hunger and thirst. Each has its own rules; many call for a **Constitution save** and can cause **Exhaustion**.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. **Falling**: 1d6 bludgeoning per 10 ft (max 20d6), land Prone.
2. **Breath**: 1 + Con mod. minutes (minimum 30 s).
3. **Extreme cold / heat**: Con save each hour.
4. **Hunger / thirst**: Exhaustion after the set time.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 keeps these hazards with fixed DCs and effects tied to **Exhaustion**.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

DCs vary by hazard and the DM can adjust them. Fix: note the chosen DCs on the table sheet.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe fatigue (cracked lips, heavy steps) before imposing Exhaustion.

Step 1 – Identify the hazard:

Falling, suffocation, fire, cold, heat, hunger or thirst.

Step 2 – Falling:

1d6 bludgeoning per 10 ft (max 20d6); you land Prone unless you avoid the damage.

Step 3 – Suffocation:

Hold breath 1 + Con mod. minutes (min 30 s). After: drop to 0 HP after rounds equal to Con mod. (min 1).

Step 4 – Temperature:

Extreme Cold: Con save DC 10 per hour. Extreme Heat: DC 5, +1 per hour. Fail: one Exhaustion level.

Step 5 – Supplies:

Without food: 3 + Con mod. days before Exhaustion. Without water: Exhaustion after a day.

Example: Mira falls 30 ft: 3d6 bludgeoning damage and she's Prone.

Hazard	Effect
Falling	1d6 bludgeoning per 10 ft, max 20d6; Prone
Suffocation	1 + Con mod. minutes (min 30 s), then 0 HP
Extreme Cold	Con save DC 10 per hour; fail: Exhaustion
Extreme Heat	Con save DC 5 (+1 per hour); fail: Exhaustion
Hunger	3 + Con mod. days (min 1); then Exhaustion
Thirst	A day without water: Exhaustion
Burning	1d4 fire per turn until extinguished

⚠ Common questions:

Can I reduce fall damage?

Yes: for example with Slow Fall.

What does falling do?

It knocks you Prone unless damage is avoided.

How long can I hold my breath?

1 + Con mod. minutes (minimum 30 seconds).

Does extreme heat tire you?

Yes: a Con save each hour.

Can I fast?

3 + Con mod. days, then Exhaustion.

Does fire go out?

An action to put out the flames.

Does a spell negate it?

Some do: Protection from Energy.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Falling onto a creature

Does the creature take half? **Option**: yes.

Water and burning

Does water extinguish flames? **Option**: yes, as an action.

Travel and hunger

The group counts rations. **Option**: one ration a day.

Exhaustion and rest

A Long Rest removes one level. **Option**: keep it.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Falling

Fall distance is counted in feet: 1d6 per 10 ft.

Exhaustion

Each level subtracts 5 ft Speed and 2 from d20 rolls.

Suffocation

After the delay, the character drops to 0 HP and is dying.

Temperature

Protection (clothing) may grant Advantage or cancel the roll.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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